As someone who knows who to say it to, I want to tell you, in his name, thank you.

Ironically, the small and poor kingdom of Jordan saw itself and the State of Israel as having identical strategic interests. Jordan never made such a declaration, but the ties between the two countries, which until the peace treaty were kept secret, have made this Jordanian thinking entirely clear.

The first contacts with Jordan were made in the 1960s and were led by Yaakov Herzog, the director general of Prime Minister Levi Eshkol's office. After the Six-Day War, senior Israeli politicians and officials regularly met King Hussein. On the eve of the Yom Kippur War in October 1973, the king sent us a warning about the impending outbreak of war. Between 1974 and 1977, meetings were held between Prime Minister Rabin and King Hussein, in which Yigal Allon and Shimon Peres also took part. During these meetings, the Israeli side expressed its willingness to discuss a partial Israeli withdrawal along the Jordan River as part of peace negotiations, but the king demanded a full withdrawal, including Jerusalem. In late 1977, a meeting was held in London between Moshe Dayan and the king, the outcome of which was silence until 1982 (it would be interesting to know what was said during this meeting). From 1982 onwards, a tradition began in which periodic meetings were held between the head of the Mossad and his Jordanian counterpart in various European cities. One might say that the significance of these meetings was the very fact that they took place.

From 1984 to 1987, a channel was established between Shimon Peres and the king under the auspices of the British Lord Mishcon. The Mossad was not a player in these talks, which began as a secret. It was not until 1987 that the British became aware of their existence. In April 1987, Peres and the king arrived at a draft peace agreement, but it was not accepted by Prime Minister Shamir. This draft later became known as the London Agreement.

Only three months after the London Agreement in July 1987, the first meeting between Prime Minister Shamir and the king took place in a castle outside London. The meeting lasted for two days—Friday and Saturday—and included many hours of talks in various constellations, including private meetings between Prime Minister Shamir and King Hussein. This meeting shaped the future relationship between the two men, which was